



Pharma logistician using IoT based on blockchain

Trushit Buch, India Lead, Codifyd Inc, is that most of such reports do not mention the exact addressable markets. He is of the view that while such reports are great for a consulting purpose, they may not be as good when it comes to the practical part.

“Primary reason in my mind is affordability. I think the addressable market is sort of driven by the affordability of the solution that it provides. IoT has been here for a while, but we should not miss the truth that large-scale manufacturers sort of survive quarter to quarter, and a lot of them see IoT as a science based experiment. Hence, most of the companies put the same under the tag of R&D department,” says Trushit Buch.

He adds, “Given these challenges, how does IoT come at the heart of operations of such companies? I think what Covid has done is, it has changed the perception of IoT from could-not-afford to the could-not-survive-without-it status. Obviously, it would be a progression that would happen, but nobody would be able to get away from it as it happens. The question at the end of the day is, whether IoT implementation would be able to generate an additional revenue channel or not, or is IoT good enough to help the organisation save tremendous amounts of money?”

“I second you on that. India was 150th on the list of most data consuming countries when the data tariffs were on the higher side. But since data became cheaper, we have become the number one consumer of data. Affordability of IoT solutions available in the market is a big factor and challenge

indeed,” says Anand.

Interestingly, a survey by Gartner notes that 47% of organisations the research and consulting company spoke to, plan to increase investments in IoT. However, the same survey also found that 35% of the respondents were looking to scale down their investments in the technology.

The biggest of these challenges comes when an organisation offering IoT services goes on to explore a new case. The experts agree that this is true in most cases, because with every company an IoT solution is pitched, the uniqueness of the use-case also changes. New use cases, in turn, affect the affordability factor further with more research and development, and in some cases the proof of concept that needs to be established.

In most such cases the IoT provider passes on the additional expenses to the client to meet RoI. Data processing further adds to the burden of additional costs as there are instances where tens of GBs of data gets generated in a single day. IoT providers, especially startups, have to find a way to compress this data, which in turn might make them lose some of it in the process.

“If you’re doing something on IoT, it’s not something that’s been explored before. It’s probably a new kind of use case. You don’t know what kind of numbers you can pitch them. How am I supposed to give across, you know, what is the amount of money you’re saving, or what value you’re going to get, when this is not something that’s been implemented before?,” explains Abhishek Satish of Vicara.

One of the answers to most of the problems mentioned so far might be co-creation. By co-creation, as Anand explains, IoT developers should work together with enablers and customers to create the solutions. Anand is of the view that co-creation helps in crossing the chasm from pilot to real-use cases.

Collaborations and end-to-end solutions

End-to-end solutioning, not a new term in business but relatively still a concept in the IoT vertical, stands for solutions that deliver big data, insight, management, operational efficiency, compliance, and automation in order to reduce operational costs. These kinds of solutions are not present in large numbers in the IoT arena, and the existing ones are either too expensive or require big-scale deployments. This simply means that a big organisation looking to implement IoT solutions, or a small organisation looking to automate its processes, might have to spend a bombshell upfront. Then comes the dilemma of use-cases and PoC, which make the problem a chicken-and-egg story.

“If I have to bundle all the solutions in an end-to-end thing, then I will end up with out-of-box requirements posted by every customer. In terms of plug-and-play solutions either I develop an end-to-end solution under my shop, or I collaborate with different providers and try to make my solution affordable. The beauty of the second model is that these providers I am working with already have solutions, and those solutions are helping me make an end-to-end solution appeal to a customer in a much better and affordable way,” says Trushit.

However, there could also be a third approach, the approach that starts with pre-integration. This approach gives creators space to create solutions by collaborating with platforms, enablers, integrators, and implementers before actually reaching out to a company for pitching solutions. This is different from the second approach as the creator here is working on a solution in advance, whereas in the second approach the creator is working on a solution after getting a list of requirements from a potential client. Also, who to col-